

Break forth, O beauteous heavenly light

Text: Johann Rist, 1641, tr. John Troutbeck ca. 1885

Music: Johann Schop, 1641

ERMUNTRE DICH 87.87.88.77

arr. J. S. Bach, 1734

The musical score is written for a four-part setting (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in G major (three sharps) and 4/4 time. It consists of four systems of staves, each with a vocal line and a basso continuo line. The lyrics are written below the vocal lines. The first system begins with a treble clef and a key signature of three sharps. The second system continues the melody. The third system features a more active vocal line with many eighth and sixteenth notes. The fourth system concludes the piece with a final cadence. The lyrics are: 'Break forth, O beau-teous heav'n - ly light, and ush - er in the morn - ing. O shep-herds, shrink not with af-fright, but hear the an - gel's warn - ing. This child, now weak in in - fan - cy, our con - fi - dence and joy shall be, the power of Sa - tan break - ing, our peace e - ter - nal mak - ing.'

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